

PHYS 143 – Mechanics and Thermal Physics
Week 2: Motion – Tutorial Sheet

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Use IDENTIFY, SET UP, EXECUTE, EVALUATE. Sketch and predict before you calculate; neglect air resistance and use $g = 9.80 \text{ m/s}^2$. Problems A1 and A2 were moved out of the lecture; full solutions follow them. Final answers to the others are at the end.

A. Moved from the lecture

A1. A train slows down

A train slows from 30.0 m/s to 10.0 m/s while travelling 200 m along a straight track. Find the (constant) acceleration and the time taken.

Solution. Take $+x$ along the motion. The time is missing, so use $v_x^2 = v_{0x}^2 + 2a_x(x - x_0)$:

$$a_x = \frac{10.0^2 - 30.0^2}{2(200)} = -2.00 \text{ m/s}^2.$$

Then $t = (v_x - v_{0x})/a_x = (10.0 - 30.0)/(-2.00) = 10.0 \text{ s}$. *Check:* the average speed is 20.0 m/s , and $20.0 \times 10.0 = 200 \text{ m}$. The sign $a_x < 0$ agrees with slowing down.

A2. Police car catching a motorist

A motorist travelling at a constant 15.0 m/s passes a stationary police car. At that instant ($t = 0$) the police car starts with constant acceleration 3.0 m/s^2 . When and where does it catch the motorist, and how fast is it then moving?

Solution. Origin at the police car, $+x$ along the road. Same position at the same time: $15.0 t = \frac{1}{2}(3.0)t^2$, so $t(1.5t - 15.0) = 0$, giving $t = 0$ or $t = 10 \text{ s}$. The root $t = 0$ is the instant the motorist passes; the physical answer is $t = 10 \text{ s}$. The position is $15.0 \times 10 = 150 \text{ m}$ and the police speed is $3.0 \times 10 = 30 \text{ m/s}$, twice the motorist's. *Check:* both x_M and x_P equal 150 m at 10 s .

B. Practice

B1. Graphs and calculus

A particle on the x -axis has $v_x = 12 - 4t$ (SI units), with $x = 0$ at $t = 0$. (a) Find a_x . (b) When is it momentarily at rest? (c) Find its displacement and the distance travelled from 0 to 5.0 s . (d) Sketch $x-t$, v_x-t and a_x-t .

B2. Free fall

(a) A ball is dropped from a 45.0 m tower. When does it land and how fast is it moving? (b) A second ball is thrown upward from the ground at 20.0 m/s . Find its maximum height, the time to reach it, and the time to return.

B3. Projectile from a cliff

A stone is thrown horizontally at 15.0 m/s from the top of a 45.0 m cliff. Find the time of flight, the horizontal distance travelled, and the speed and direction of the stone when it lands.

B4. Circular motion

The Moon orbits the Earth in a nearly circular path of radius $3.84 \times 10^8 \text{ m}$ with period 27.3 days. Find its speed and the magnitude of its acceleration.

B5. Relative velocity

An aircraft has an airspeed of 200 km/h . A wind blows toward the east at 60 km/h . (a) If the pilot points the aircraft due north, find its velocity relative to the ground. (b) In what direction must the pilot point to fly due north over the ground, and what is the ground speed then?

B6. Challenge: the method is not given

A passenger in a train moving at 20.0 m/s east throws a ball straight up, at 8.0 m/s relative to the train. Describe the motion as seen from the train and from the ground. Where does the ball land relative to the passenger, and how far along the track has it travelled relative to the ground?

Answers

B1 (a) -4.0 m/s^2 ; (b) $t = 3.0 \text{ s}$; (c) displacement $+10 \text{ m}$, distance 26 m

B2 (a) 3.03 s , -29.7 m/s ; (b) 20.4 m , 2.04 s , 4.08 s

B3 3.03 s ; 45.5 m ; 33.3 m/s at 63.2° below the horizontal

B4 $1.02 \times 10^3 \text{ m/s}$; $2.7 \times 10^{-3} \text{ m/s}^2$

B5 (a) 209 km/h at 16.7° east of north; (b) 17.5° west of north, ground speed 191 km/h

B6 Train: straight up and down, flight time 1.63 s . Ground: a parabola. The ball lands in the passenger's hand;